put it, ‘That era has gone when two leaders in Delhi would shake each other’s hands in a drawing room and behind them a voter will follow like a bonded labourer. A voter decides his vote himself and uses it on the basis of what is better for his area, his country and for himself.’

Modi and Shah undoubtedly brought with them a new energy and a different leadership style to the BJP from 2014 onwards, and it completely changed how the party was run in the Vajpayee and Advani years. Naturally, this also created heartburn among the old guard. As a senior state BJP leader, not considered close to them, told me on condition of anonymity, ‘They took the party to another level. There is no question about that. But they don’t have a personal touch. They focus on delivery, which is good, but personal touch is missing. But you cannot deny that their style and result-oriented approach also brought victories.’